

Arduino

The latest innovation within the open source fraternity is the Arduino, an open source prototyping platform used to design flexible embedded electronic systems, capable of various applications ranging from simple sensors to complex applications (such as running a web server). The community offers the hardware, with the intention of using the skills of millions of programmers, who come up with a final product that's superior and bug free. Another reason is to offer customisation. Open source stuff can be customised as per the user's content but you need a bit of programming skills to achieve that. Arduino programming involves C/C++ and the development environment



utilities are compliant to GNU Public Licence and Copyleft. If you know C/C++, working on Arduino is simple as it has been reduced from mastering micro-controllers and implementing design to just coding in the Arduino development environment. No need to rack your brains understanding the design of the system, just rush to application development. While the system will be cheapest if assembled by hand, pre-assembled kits are also available for around ₹1,500.

Raspberry Pi

The Raspberry Pi is a credit card sized computer that you can plug into your TV or monitor. Add a keyboard and a mouse and it's ready to run. It runs Linux (either Ubuntu or ArchLinux). Unfortunately it doesn't run Windows as Windows doesn't support ARM 11. If you've been lucky enough to see a Raspberry Pi, you may have noticed a crucial thing missing on the miniature device – the secondary storage. That's because it uses a SD card as a

